Mes Aynak provides a *comparandum*. See *infra* in main text for possible military uses of the four-*iwan* structure with corner bastions, e.g., at Sarkhushak.

66. It is noteworthy that, as early as the eleventh century, Persian poets of the eastern Islamic world such as Gurgani (fl. *c*. 1050 CE) were familiar with Buddhist monasteries, whose square plans, central courtyards flanked by *ivan*-like alcoves, and even interior paintings inspired metaphorical references, or may have served as devices of *mis-en-scène* (cf. Melikian-Chirvani 1982: 6–7; and Introduction). This apparent first-hand familiarity with Buddhist monastic interiors could have come from remnants of these structures in the landscape, and/or the result of their not infrequent repurposing as *madrasa*s or other identifiably Islamic purposes.
67. Cf. Le Berre 1987: 88–93; Baker and Allchin 1991: 161–179; Thomas 2018: 118–119; Ball 2019: No. 1004. Baker and Allchin confirmed the dating with analysis of surface ceramic finds, consisting mostly of sgraffiato wares and one sherd of lusterware from Rayy, all datable to the late twelfth–early thirteenth centuries.
68. It is indeed unfortunate that Juzjani did not describe Sarkhushak's supposed palatial structures in his section on the Bamiyan Shansabanis; they would have surely lent themselves with ease to the metaphorical apprehension of the palace as a symbol of royal greatness, common in eastern Persianate literary culture during the twelfth century (cf. *supra* the section on Firuzkuh).
69. Quite possibly, Baker and Allchin's Building E (Figure 3.25), occupying the promontory's highest point (to the north of the multi-level, graded residential/palatial structure), was a commemorative structure with a *mihrab*. While the other mosque (Building F) exhibited an east–west rectangular plan axially oriented along the *qibla*, Building E's compact footprint and profile essentially comprised a domed cube with addorsed entrance on the east – on axis with the western wall's *mihrab* – making it directly comparable to the eleventh- or early twelfth-century *ziyarat* of Imam-i Khurd near Sar-i Pul (ancient Anbir). Cf. Bivar 1966: esp. 57–62; Blair 1992: 201; Ball and Fischer 2019: 487.
70. The basic plan of the quadrangular structure (Building D), with its four circular bastions at the corners, is clearly evocative of the possibly repurposed Buddhist monastery of Danestama and other Central Asian Buddhist monastic structures (see *supra* in main text). It should also be mentioned that dyed and folded textiles were recovered from Building D, which of course does not necessarily preclude its simultaneous function as a military garrison. Cf. Baker and Allchin 1991: 163.
71. For the Indic elements cf. esp. Le Berre 1987: 92; Baker and Allchin 1991: 63, 65, 163. The introduction of Indic construction methods urges consideration of a late twelfth-century date for at least some Sarkhushak structures, as the Shansabanis' Indian campaigns arguably brought more skilled laborers westward from India, as proposed in Volume II.
72. The résumé here of the findings from Shahr-i Ghulghula emerged from the invaluable archaeological fieldwork in 2014–2015 around the Bamiyan region conducted by Thomas Lorain (Scientific Secretary, DAFA); while areas of Shahr-i Ghulghula's western slope were surveyed and some also excavated,